Walking-talking mocks

Attempt, diagnose, model and re-check

Use an active walking-talking mock to combine expert modelling with student attempts and diagnosis. Give explanation time where the responses show it is needed.

How to do it well

1 Attempt and commit. Work through one question at a time; students write an answer and confidence rating before any model is shown.

2 Gather evidence. Use boards for a final answer, first decision or line of working; allocate staff scanning zones where necessary.

3 Model responsively. Confirm secure work briefly or explain the specific difficulty, making expert decisions visible.

4 Recheck and stretch. Use a fresh equivalent question after teaching, then a What If variation where the underlying idea is secure.

5 Create Review Cards. Begin with high-confidence errors, record the mistake and corrected example, and schedule later self-quizzing.

What this sounds like

“Try this question first and rate your confidence. Show the first line of working. We will model the part causing difficulty, then everyone will attempt a related question.”

Classroom example. During mock review, pupils attempt a question and rate confidence before staff scan boards in zones. A common first-step error receives a short model and a fresh shadow question. Secure answers receive a purposeful What If variation. Pupils then build Review Cards from selected errors instead of leaving only with an annotated paper.

Top tips that make the technique work

Attempt before the model. Students need a chance to make decisions before seeing the teacher’s solution.

Commit confidence before feedback. A score alongside the answer helps identify confidently held errors for later review.

Scan in zones. Where several staff are present, assign areas so every response can be seen.

Use equivalent follow-ups. A shadow question can check the repaired idea without students simply copying the original.

Make the revision usable. Review Cards give students a question they can test themselves on later.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Use responses to decide explanation time.	Teacher talk through the whole paper before pupils attempt it.
Include a recheck and later retrieval.	Giving every question identical treatment regardless of need.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

Barton — Walking-Talking Mock Exams